



Malpractice & Maladministration Policy

Overleaf Publishers Ltd — Chainsaw Courses Platform

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Malpractice and Maladministration Policy	1.0	July 2026	July 2027

1 | Policy Statement

Overleaf Publishers Ltd is committed to maintaining the integrity of its assessments and qualifications. Malpractice and maladministration undermine the value of certification and may create serious safety risks in a vocational context such as chainsaw operation. This policy sets out what constitutes malpractice and maladministration, how suspected cases will be investigated, and the consequences for those found responsible.

2 | Definitions

Term	Definition
Learner Malpractice	Any deliberate act by a learner intended to give them an unfair advantage in any assessment, or to circumvent platform security measures
Maladministration	Any act or omission by the organisation or its staff that results in incorrect or inconsistent assessment, certification, or administration
Plagiarism	Presenting another person's work or words as one's own (where applicable to written submissions)
Collusion	Sharing answers, assessment content, or activation codes with other individuals to gain or confer an unfair advantage
Impersonation	Having another person complete an assessment on one's behalf, or completing an assessment on behalf of another person
Fabrication	Creating false records, evidence, or results in connection with any assessment activity
Platform Misuse	Circumventing device-lock security, sharing activation codes, or attempting to access another learner's account

3 | Examples of Malpractice

3.1 Learner Malpractice

- Sharing an activation code with another person so that they can access the platform
- Allowing another person to complete module quizzes or the final examination on their behalf
- Using unauthorised materials or assistance during a timed or proctored assessment
- Attempting to access, copy, or distribute examination questions outside of the assessment environment
- Providing false personal details during registration or activation
- Attempting to circumvent device-lock security through technical means

3.2 Maladministration

- Issuing a certificate to a learner who has not met the required assessment standard
- Failing to apply an agreed reasonable adjustment to a learner's account
- Inaccurate recording of assessment results in the platform database
- Failure to maintain the confidentiality of learner data
- Failure to follow the appeals procedure within the stated timescales

4 | Detection

Overleaf Publishers Ltd employs the following controls to detect malpractice:

- Device-lock technology that bonds each activation code to a single device on first use
- Dynamic watermarking on all video content displaying the learner's registered name and email
- Server-side logging of all assessment attempts with timestamps, device IDs, and IP address metadata
- Analysis of examination completion times — unusually rapid completion may trigger manual review
- Administrator review of all attempts where a specific question is challenged via the appeals process
- Monitoring for repeated activation from multiple devices or unusual login patterns

5 | Investigation Procedure

1. Suspected malpractice identified by monitoring systems, complaints, or the appeals process is logged and referred to the Managing Director
2. The learner or person suspected is notified in writing within 5 working days that a malpractice investigation is underway
3. Evidence is gathered including platform logs, device data, assessment records, and any other relevant information
4. The learner is given the opportunity to respond to the allegations and provide any evidence in their defence
5. The Managing Director conducts an impartial investigation and reaches a finding within 20 working days
6. The learner is notified of the outcome in writing with full reasons
7. Where malpractice is confirmed, appropriate sanctions are applied (see Section 6)
8. All investigation records are retained for a minimum of 5 years

6 | Sanctions

Where malpractice is confirmed, the following sanctions may be applied proportionately:

- Formal written warning recorded on the learner's account
- Invalidation of the affected assessment attempt(s) and any certificate issued as a result
- Suspension or permanent termination of platform access without refund
- Referral to IIRSM (as the approving body) where the malpractice is of a serious nature
- In cases of suspected criminal fraud, referral to the relevant authorities

7 | Reporting to IIRSM

Overleaf Publishers Ltd will report all confirmed cases of serious malpractice or maladministration to IIRSM as required under the terms of course approval. Reports will include the nature of the incident, the investigation findings, and the actions taken. IIRSM reserves the right to conduct its own investigation and to withdraw course approval in serious cases.

8 | Appeals against Malpractice Findings

A learner who disagrees with a malpractice finding or sanction may appeal under the formal Appeals Policy. The appeal must be submitted within 20 working days of receiving the malpractice decision.